Certain books proved very useful in clearing some doubts about the jigsaw puzzle that the operation was. Others corroborated some of the information that had come to my attention while in service. Some of these books were written by senior government officials who held crucial posts at that time. These include: *From Poona to Prime Minister's Office* by B.G Deshmukh, former cabinet secretary, *Through the Corridors of Power* by P.C. Alexander, then principal secretary to the PM, and *Kaoboys of R&AW: Down Memory Lane* by B. Raman, former additional secretary, R&AW. Some others that I have relied on were written by well-known journalists – for instance, *Amritsar: Mrs Gandhi's Last Battle* by Mark Tully and Satish Jacob; *Beyond the Lines* : *An Autobiography* by Kuldip Nayar, and *Bloodshed in Punjab: Untold Saga of Deceit and Sabotage* by G.S. Chawla. *1984: Anti-Sikh Violence,* an eyewitness account of the anti-Sikh pogrom in Delhi by Sanjay Suri, who was at the time a young reporter with the *Indian Express* , was an eye-opener on two counts – it made plain the role of some Congress leaders in the 1984 pogrom and the inaction and even connivance of some Delhi police officials; and it corroborated what I had heard on the Delhi police wireless network, which I monitored on my personal radio for three days from 1–3 November 1984. My special thanks to all these authors.

Soon after the manuscript of my previous book on Sikkim's merger with India was given to the publishers in early 2018, I started preparing handwritten notes about the events described in this book. After the release of *Sikkim: Dawn of Democracy* , I started dictating the contents of those notes to my daughter, Harmeeta, and they came in handy for inclusion in this book. She continued to help me by taking dictation as and when I needed it. My son Gagan helped me locate relevant material on the internet and also in reading the draft manuscript at the pre-editing and editing stages, making some important suggestions, which have been incorporated. I am grateful to both for their help.

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